THE MISSION OF THE CHURCH, OUR COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY

Today, we celebrate World Mission Sunday. We set aside this day every year to think, talk and reflect about the mission which Jesus entrusted to his disciples and to us in Mathew's Gospel.

Pope Francis once reflected that "today, every land is a 'mission land' and every dimension of human life is mission territory". This marks a major shift in how the Church views its role in the modern world. Historically, "the missions" meant sending missionaries from stablished Christian nations to far-off countries. Today, the Pope emphasises that the global landscape has completely transformed. Several factors must have caused this; the collapse of Christendom, geographical and human boundaries.

On the other hand, Pope Leo chose the official theme for the centenary celebration of World Mission Sunday: **"One in Christ, United in Mission".** Pope Leo emphasized that through baptism; every single person becomes a member of the Body of Christ and holds a unique responsibility to cooperate as one family to spread the Gospel. He noted that evangelisation is fundamentally "always a work of love"

There are two ways to be a missionary: we can give to mission by going and we can go to mission by giving.

Dear brothers and sisters let us be activ

Your **Mission Sunday** donation en
mission in the church, should be retu



Monday, 19th October - Ss John de Brébeuf, Isaac Jogues & Companions

8.00am: Veronica Curejova (A)
10.00am: Francis Callinan (A)

Tuesday, 20th October

8.00am: Special Intention
10.00am: Donald Smith & Marie Fennessy Smith (Dec'd)

Wednesday, 21st October

8.00am: Frank Devine
10.00am: Elizabeth Quinn-Shields (A)

Thursday, 22nd October - St John Paul II

8.00am: Ben McGowan (A)
10.00am: Holy Souls
7.30pm Curry: Deceased Members of Finn Family, Caldramore

Friday, 23rd October - St John of Capistrano

8.00am: Patrick McDonnell (A)
10.00am: Tony Flaherty & Joe Shaughnessy (B'day Rem)

Saturday, 24th October - St Anthony Mary Claret

8.00am: Ita Donlon (1st Anniv)
10.00am: Mary & Tom McGinn (A)

Sunday, 25th October - Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time

7.30pm Vigil: Mary Brennan (A)
Patrick & Annie McKeon, son PJ, daughter Patricia & DFM

8.00am: **Mass for People of the Parish (Missa Pro Populo)**

10.00am: No Intention

11.30am: Patrick Manicle (3rd A)
Colette Oates (A)

1.00pm: Frank Kenny (Month's Mind)
Danny Conway (A)

6.00pm: Ints of McErlean family, of Karen & Theresa Herbison & for the repose of the soul of Thomas McErlean Snr

OFFERTORY COLLECTION: Thank you most sincerely for your generous contribution to our collection last week which amounted to €4,445.

CONGRATULATIONS to Martin McManus and Rose Muleta who gave themselves to each other in holy matrimony during the week.

† RECENTLY DECEASED We remember in our prayers Esther Casey (Stonepark) and Margaret Taylor (nee Healy) (late of Birmingham/formerly Farnagh) who died last weekend, whose funeral arrangements will be announced later. May their souls, and the souls of all the faithful departed, rest in peace.

ANNUAL BEREAVEMENT MASS 2026 will take place on **Saturday 7th November** at the **7.30pm** mass. The 2027 Diary is now available for those who would like to book a **First Anniversary Mass**. The Diary will be available from **Monday 2nd November** for booking of all other masses.

SACRAMENTAL PREPARATION outside of school. A short preparation course will take place during Lent for children who may not have been Baptised - or who are Baptised and may not have received First Holy Communion or Confirmation - and wish to do so in 2026. These classes will commence on **Thursday 11th February 2027** and continue throughout Lent. Please contact the Parish Office - 04333 46465 - to arrange enrolment in the preparation course.

OCIA - Order of Christian Initiation for Adults - Do you want to be baptised? Do you want to enter full communion with the Church? The OCIA is a programme of formation in the faith. Classes for over-18 year olds who would like to be baptised, OR who are baptised and would like to make their First Holy Communion or Confirmation, will commence early November. Please contact the Parish Office.

LONGFORD SANCTUARY, funded by Longford Hospice Homecare, and provided by LARCC is a new service to be delivered in Longford. Information evening on **Wednesday 21st October @ 7.30pm** in Slashers Complex, Farneyhoogan. All are invited to attend. Refreshments will be served.

NEW ALTAR SERVERS APPEAL: If your son or daughter has received First Holy Communion, we appeal to you to strongly encourage them to become an altar server at St Mel's Cathedral. It is an opportunity to be of service to others, to grow in respect and reverence for the things of God, and become attentive to Jesus speaking in their hearts.

The commitment involves wanting to be an example that can bring others closer to God but you will find it can also be a means to daw your family closer to each other. Through you, it is Jesus who invites your family to hear his call and follow him.

Please collect a form from the Sacristy in the Cathedral and return it to the Sacristy or to the Parish Office.

BOOKSTAND will be available in the porch at all masses next weekend **24th/25th October** with books to borrow or buy.

RESPONSE: **Give the Lord glory and power.**

GOSPEL READING: Matthew 22: 15-21

The Pharisees went away to work out between them how to trap Jesus in what he said. And they sent their disciples to him, together with the Herodians, to say, *'Master, we know that you are an honest man and teach the way of God in an honest way, and that you are not afraid of an nothing to you. Tell us your opinion, then. Is or not?*



But Jesus was aware of their malice and repl *'You hypocrites! Why do you set this trap for tax with.'*

They handed him a denarius and he said, 'W

'Caesar's' they replied.

He then said to them, *'Very well, give back to Caesar what belongs to Caesar – and to God what belongs to God.'*

***** ***** *****

POPE'S INTENTION FOR OCTOBER - ***For mental health ministry***

Let us pray that the mental health ministry be established throughout the Church, helping to overcome the stigma and discrimination of persons with mental illnesses.

***** ***** *****

THANK YOU - The following is an extract from the letter of thanks received from Br. Brian Johnson, OSF, for our parish contribution which totalled €7,413:

"We are most grateful to you for your tremendous kindness and generosity towards our mission. The brothers in Kenya and Uganda and the people among whom we work, will be thrilled to know of your great concern for them and of your wonderful generosity. It will be a huge boost to them in these hard times of drought, food shortage and the cutbacks in USAID and Aid from other countries. We will be good guardians of the huge trust you have placed in us. We will use the resources you have given us wisely and efficiently. Every cent of your contribution will go directly to our missions.

I have little to offer in return for your tremendous kindness and generosity, except to let you know that you are remembered in the daily prayers of the brothers. You and your families will be remembered with a climb of Croagh Patrick, and a small fast."

Newtowncashel https://images.squarespace-cdn.com/content/v1/69c01534a155cc487bfc777e/7fc87500-7766-4c88-9cc0-9e826447650e/Newsletter_20261018.png





PARISH OF CASHEL NEWSLETTER

Merlyn Kenny 086 0603433 - 29th Sunday in Ordinary Time A 26





Sat	17th	Oct	8.00pm:	Gabriel Mulvihill, Loughfarm, Elfeet, (1st anniv). Rem. Bridge & dfm of the Mulvihill & Hanley families.
Mon	19th	Oct	8.00pm:	John & Bridie Rowan, Derrygowna.
Tues	20th	Oct	8.00pm:	Special Intention.
Thurs	22nd	Oct	8.00pm:	Special Intention.
Fri	23rd	Oct	8.00pm:	Special Intention.
Sat	24th	Oct	8.00pm:	Michael Bawle, Portanure, (4th anniv).

Eucharistic Adoration - continues Wednesday from 3pm-9pm & Friday 8.30pm-9pm.

Rosary: Sat 17th Oct: Peg Boyce. Sat 24th Oct: Margaret Bawle.

Eucharistic Ministers' Roster: Sat 24th Oct: Thomas Dennigan & Laura Dermody.

Readers' Roster: Sat 24th Oct: Gerry Farrell.

Collection for Mission Sunday will take place this weekend. Details of Mission account for those who wish to deposit directly to this account: Bank of Ireland, IBAN: IE-47BOFI90178124827176.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend: Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend. St. Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo. Friday 9th to Sunday 11th April 2027. This residential weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

Lotto draw held on Monday 12th October 2026. No's drawn: 08-11-20-28. No jackpot winner. Draw winners: €30 €5 envelopes to Sean Melia, €30 to Michael Collins, €20 each to Sean Nolan and Jimmy Leavy. Next weeks draw will be held in The Local on Monday 19th October and the Jackpot is €4,600. Lotto team on next week's draw is Emily Farrell, Ger Farrell and Gary Beattie. Thanks for your support.

Pope Leo dedicates his October prayer intention to mental health ministry, calling on the Church to listen without judging and accompany those who suffer without excluding them. "We bring before you O Lord, our brothers and sisters who struggle with challenges to their mental health, who suffer in solitude with anxiety, depression, or any other mental illness," he prays. Pope Leo asks forgiveness for the times when Christians have looked the other way, contributing to stigma and discrimination against people with mental illnesses. He prays that the Church may become "a safe space where everyone has a place - a community that accompanies and never excludes, that listens without judging and draws near without fear." The Pope also remembers those who provide care, including professionals, family members and volunteers, asking God to give them strength and compassion. "Send your Spirit upon us, that we may learn to welcome and integrate care for mental health into the life and ministry of our communities and of the whole Church," he concludes, "and thus become a living sign of your mercy, which never abandons and always restores."

October Prayer to Our Lady

Sweet Mother, do not part from me.
Turn not your eyes away from me.
Walk with me at every moment
and never leave me alone.
You who always protect me
as a true Mother,
obtain for me the blessing of the Father,
Son and Holy Spirit.

Simple explanation of Jesus' message today

1) it is the duty of Christians to pay for the services and the privileges that the state provides -- like Hospitals, paved roads, police and fire departments, schools, and Social welfare amongst other necessities.

2) We must respect the laws of our country in order to live in peace.

3) When the state oversteps the mark and puts itself in the place of God, Christians are, as a last resort, absolved from obedience. "We must give to Caesar the things that are Caesar's and To God the things that are God's." *If there is a clash between God's law and man's we as 'Christians must put Him first.*

2) <u>We need to *"give to God what is God's"*: How?</u> Since everything is God's, we must give ourselves to Him 100%, not just 10% on Sundays. We should be generous in fulfilling our Sunday obligations, and we should find time every day for prayer and worship in the family, for the reading of the Bible, and for the proper training of our children in Faith and morals. St. Augustine teaches that when we truly succeed in *"giving to God what is God's,"* we are *"doing justice to God."* This requires that we return to God, with dividends, that which God has entrusted to us, remembering that we are mere managers or stewards of God's gifts.

The common theme of today's readings is the nature of our obligations to God and to our country. The readings show us how, with God's help, we can be ideal citizens of both earth and Heaven. In the Gospel, Jesus escapes from the trap in the question, "*Is it lawful to pay the census tax to Caesar or not?*" by stating, "*Repay to Caesar what belongs to Caesar and to God what belongs to God.*" By this answer, Jesus reminds His questioners that if they are that concerned and careful about paying taxes to the state, they should be much more concerned and careful about their service to God and their obligations to Him as their Creator and Lord. In other words God requires worship from us. It is all we can give Him in the end. That's all I had to give Him when lying on my back in Hospital and not allowed to turn left or right in case of doing damage to the healing process.